



Comparative Religion on Islam in Publications from 2010-2020: A Thematic Review

AEMY ELYANI MAT ZAIN¹ & JAFFARY AWANG²

ABSTRACT

Research related to the field of Comparative Religion and Islamic attachment has been gone several changes and debates recently. It involved with variety of trends that discussed in the previous publication. Despite its growth, there is no review paper discussing the prevalent trends about the Comparative Religion on Islam in the literature. This review was motivated by the belief that harmonious engagement between Comparative Religion and Islam suggests that the need to explore more aspects related with Islam and Comparative Religion field. Therefore, the purpose of this systematic review is to synthesize literature from 2010 to 2020 related the trends about Comparative Religion on Islam using thematic review. A keyword search, followed by a filter using inclusion criteria from SCOPUS and Mendeley databases, recognized 77 scholarly journal articles. However, after the inclusion and exclusion process, only 27 articles were used as the final articles to be reviewed. A thematic review of these 27 articles recognized 15 initial codes characterizing the trends of the discussion in literature, grouped in 7 clusters; academic and art, concept of religion, engagement Islam with others, ideologies, people thought, practising and sacred in religions and young generation. The results advantage for the future study on Islamic trends in comparative religion and can be a parameter for exploring extensively other things regarding this field.

9204

Keywords: Trends, Comparative religion on Islam, ATLAS.ti 8, thematic review

DOI Number: 10.14704/nq.2022.20.6.NQ22903 **NeuroQuantology** 2022; 20(6): 9204-9223

¹ **Aemy Elyani Mat Zain** (Corresponding Author), Doctorate Candidate of Institute Islam Hadhari, Universiti Kebangsaan Malaysia (UKM); Lecturer of Department of Islamic Understanding and Thought, Centre for Core Studies, Kolej Universiti Islam Antarabangsa Selangor (KUIS). Tel: 03-8911 7000 E-mail: aemyelyani@kuis.edu.my

² **Jaffary Awang**, Chairperson of Centre for Aqidah and Global Peace, Faculty of Islamic Studies; Senior Research Fellow of Institute Islam Hadhari, Universiti Kebangsaan Malaysia (UKM). Tel: 03-8921 5520 E-mail: jaffary@ukm.edu.my



Introduction

Nowadays, the world has been continuously changing in every single of human life including the academicians field. As we know the field of comparative religion is prevalently discussed among the scholars of the world in any types of discussion. Even from time to time, the discussion related with comparative religion on Islam is growing and details discussion needed regarding on this context.

It is indisputably that some of the scholars in the field of comparative religion who discussed this field in the view of Islamic perspective believed that Islam is a universal religion. It can be proven as reported by (Dakake 2019:361) said that "The Qur'an and early Islamic texts discuss religion as a universal, discreet, and identifiable aspect of human existence, while also identifying Islam as a universal religion". Even, in the other aspect, Islam is generally understood as the name of the religion brought by the last prophet, Muhammad which implied the spiritual vision of the Quran and recognized various pre-Muhammadan prophets and their followers as Muslims. This showed that how universal Islam is because Islam does not only deal with its Muslim followers but Islam is also dealing with people of the other religion.

Despite on that, there are still some issues arisen that discussed regarding comparative religion on Islam whether it seen as a controversy or not. The first one is about some misunderstanding about Islam among the people especially people of other religion. Some of them see that Islam is the religion of compulsion or religion of terrorist. This things always happened when the media brought the news related with terrorism such as (Hassan 2014:65) mentioned in his study discussed on some of electronic media that spread the news on Muslim Pakistan's population propagated militant ideologies and

this actually impact of bad sight for Islam. Other than that, the same thing happened in the West country such bombing, hijacking and attacking by Islamic terrorist that make some of people misunderstand on the religion of Islam. This has been reported by (Nussio 2020:1) taken by Vergani's book mentioned that "Islamist terrorist attacks in the Western World have repeatedly led to heightened level of trust in government, national identification, prejudice towards outsiders and emotions like fear and anger". In reality Islam is not the religion of compulsion, even not the religion of terrorist. This thing clearly addressed by the holy Quran that ask Muslims to live peacefully with people of other religion (Mustapha & Abdul Razak 2019: 72). Even, throughout the history of Islamic civilization showed that how Islam is growing peacefully and continuously from the teaching of the previous prophets. As said by (Musthafa 2014:14) that "In the 7th century after Jesus Christ, the rise of Islam in the era of the Prophet Muhammad came through disseminating the religion's message in the 'medium' most widely available at the time: the spoken and written word". Somehow, we can see that the propagating of the religion message in Islam mainly because of dakwah which continuously doing by previous people.

In this scenario, it is not only issues in terms of misunderstood by some people on Islam dealing with other religions. There is also issue regarding on confrontation between muslim and western scholars approaching in other religion. Some of confrontation between both scholars happened when they failed to achieve consensus in certain issues, like (Mustapha & Abdul Razak 2019:72) said "failed to observed the maxim of agree to disagree". We can see clear cut on Islamic and Christian conception on religion such as universality of religion as a human experience. This we can see as



reported by (Dakake 2019:345) mentioned that “the Islamic conception of religion, as manifest in Qur’anic and early Islamic hadith discourse, seems to be constructed quite independently of Christian thought, and is both distinctive and internally coherent”.

Even, the other issue that arisen around comparative religion on Islam which is the character or personality of preacher in the field of comparative religion. As said by (Lee 2004: 534) that the role of the personality of the preacher in preaching is very important because preaching reflects the real life of a preacher. Like some of Muslim preacher in the field of comparative religion, they have several characteristics in approaching the people of other religion. The foremost personality that they should have which is knowledgeable not only in the religion of Islam, but also they have knowledge of other religion and even the other religions’ holy scriptures. This has been argued by (Eisenlohr 2017:8 ; Mustapha & Abdul Razak 2019:79 ; Musthafa 2014:17 ; Ridwan 2017:7 ; Samuel & Rozario 2010:431) mentioned that the ability of the muslim preacher in mastering religious scriptures give them the confidence to face and engage with people of other religions. Hence, this personality of preacher which knowledgeable is really meaningful in terms of approaching people of other religions.

Likewise, the argument of the characteristic and personality of preacher is not only knowledgeable in religious scriptures. Many recent studies also mentioned on the media practices is also important especially in our contemporary life. Therefore, having the televangelist channel or televised presentation is the other characteristic of Muslim preacher in approaching people of other religions. It is such a new form of religious broadcasting using social media

which combining television and evangelism (Musthafa 2014:14). A case in point as reported by (Samuel & Rozario 2010:430) in his finding on Muslim televangelist, one of the respondent really love of this preacher because he has answers to all questions not only referring to Quran as his sources, but he also reads Gita and Bible. This is the values of muslim preacher in the field of comparative religion is about.

On the other hand, there is also studies contend that some approaches by Muslim preacher towards other people of religion need for revision to make sure the harmonious co-existence between Muslim and people of other religion still remained. This we can see on what mentioned by (Mustapha & Abdul Razak 2019:76) which there is some Muslim preacher approaches to other religions is quite rigid and uncompromising stand towards the opinions of others. As far as this approach is concerned, the researchers believe it may relate with the background of the preacher itself and his surrounding which indirectly reflects on the ways of his approaches to the others. Realizing this issue, the researchers further to explore of the prevalent trends that been discussed in the Comparative Religion on Islam publications from the year 2010-2020 as through the following research question:

What are the prevalent trends discussed in the literature about Comparative Religion on Islam from the year 2010 to 2020?

Materials and Methods

Doing research on thematic review using ATLAS.ti as the tool that being introduced by some qualitative scholars such (Soratto et al. 2020:2 ; Zairul 2020:1) are implemented because the technique of this study applies thematic analysis process in a literature



review. Clarke & Braun (2013:120) define thematic analysis is a process of recognizing the pattern and construct themes over thorough reading on the subject. The following step is to identify the prevalent trends discussed in Comparative Religion on Islam. The research principles are to analyse and interpret the findings for the recommendation of future research in Comparative Religion on Islam. The selection

At the first step, by doing keywords search string which is "comparative religion" AND "islam" OR "muslim" without any filtering from both databases, the results was 59 documents in SCOPUS and 51 documents in Mendeley. Then, the researchers narrowed down the searching by filtering the year of publications; from 2010-2020. The result of the filtering as below

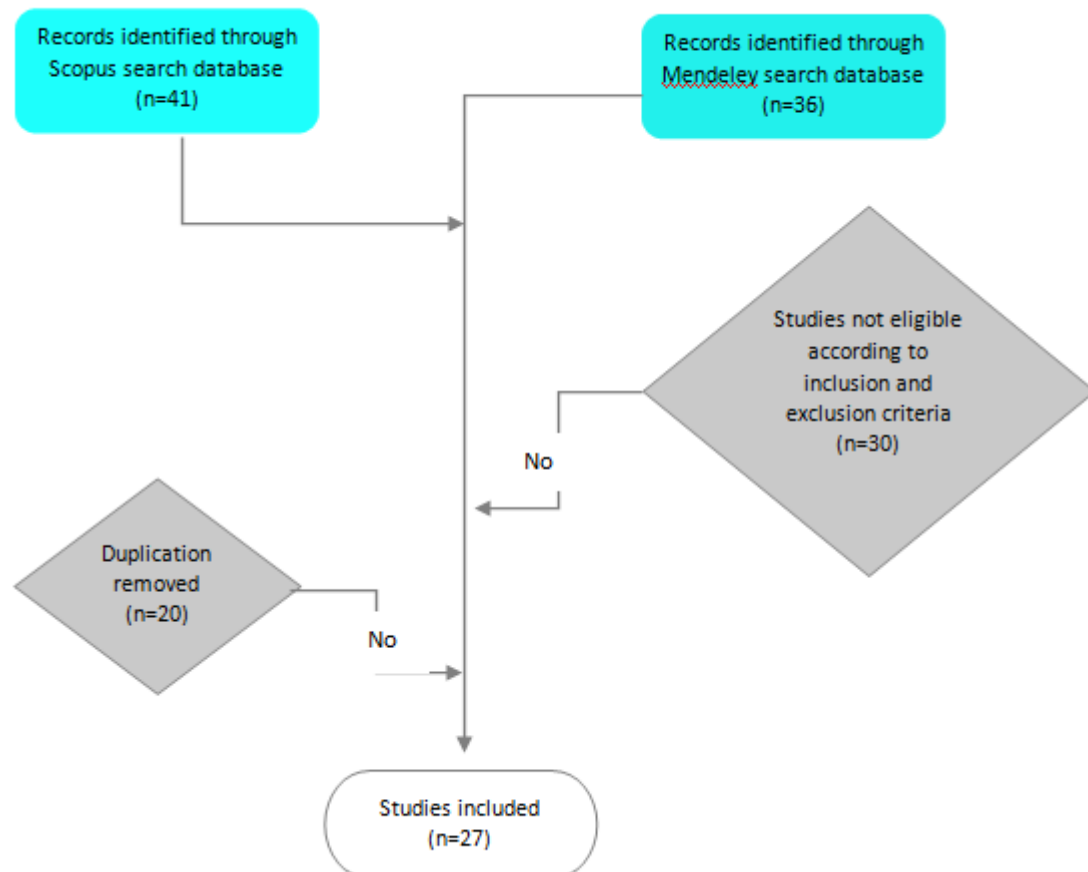
of literature was performed according to several selection criteria: 1) publication from 2010-2020, 2) Have at least keyword(s) which are Comparative Religion, Islam or Muslim. The decision to limit the Comparative Religion on Islam was made to help the future researchers extensively explore the other trends that not covered yet in this field on knowledge.

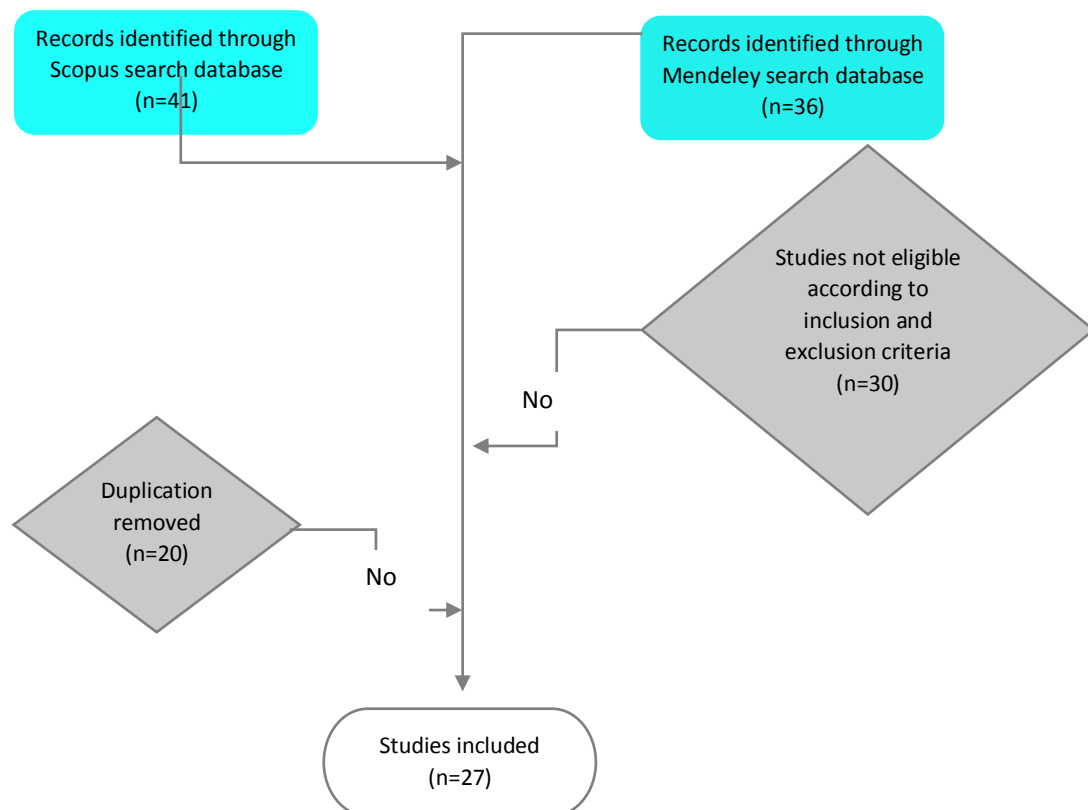
SCOPUS	"comparative religion" AND "islam" OR "muslim"	41 results
Mendeley	"comparative religion" AND "islam" OR "muslim"	36 results

Table 1: Search strings from Scopus and Mendeley

The review process is limited to scholarly journal and the next step involves scanning and removing the insignificant documents like duplication papers, books and conference reports. This step has finally reduced the number of articles with 27 papers being shortlisted for the study (see Figure 1)







9209

Figure 1: Inclusion and Exclusion criteria in the thematic review

Then, all 27 metadata from the Mendeley were transferred to ATLAS.ti 8 and created as primary documents. There were several groupings were later initiated automatically in the code group as shown in Figure 2. The automatic classifications in the ATLAS.ti 8 really made the reviewing process are easier and systematically structured when it comes to data sorting. The first round of coding process produced 15 initial codes which were then grouped in several themes related with the study inquiry which is “What are the prevalent trends discussed in the literature about Comparative Religion on Islam from the year 2010 to 2020?”. The findings of the review will be presented in two parts which are Quantitative findings and Qualitative findings.

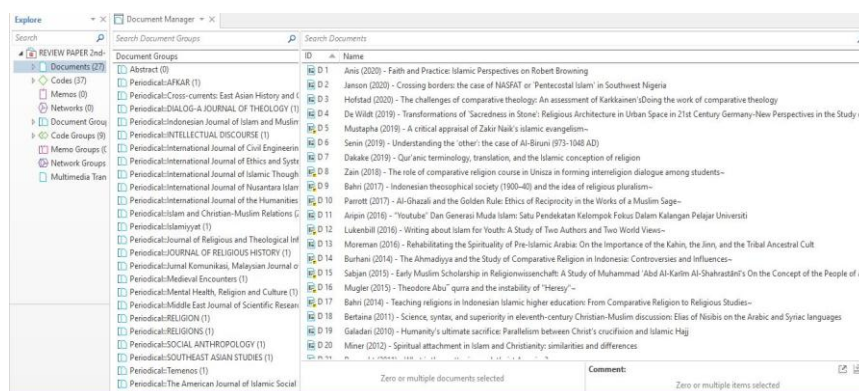


Figure 2: The emergence of the code group from Mendeley metadata



Results and Discussions

Quantitative results

Based on the fig.3: word cloud generated from 27 documents showed the term 'Islam' used 1138 times, while 'Religion' was mentioned 978 times, similarly the term 'Religious' is 976 times. Meanwhile the term 'muslim' was mentioned 588 times. Even, in terms of frequency throughout the years, the trends explained that on 2016 and 2019 got the highest number of publications which is four papers as showed at fig.4. Therefore, based on the thematic analysis on the selected articles and sequence of frequency, the present discussion was based on the following themes.

In addition, throughout the paper meant for comparative religion on Islam, the journals recorded that the articles were published varies. These research strings are either directly referenced in the recognized 27 articles through several periodicals like; AFKAR, Indonesian Journal of Islam and Muslim Societies, Intellectual Discourse, Southeast Asian Studies etc (Fig. 4). As far as the journal of publications are concerned, it found that there are 3 years directly published in Journal of Religious and Theological Information which is on 2015, 2016 and 2017. Followed by Islam and Christian-Muslim Relations' journal that published twice throughout the publications on 2011 and 2014 (Fig.5).

9210

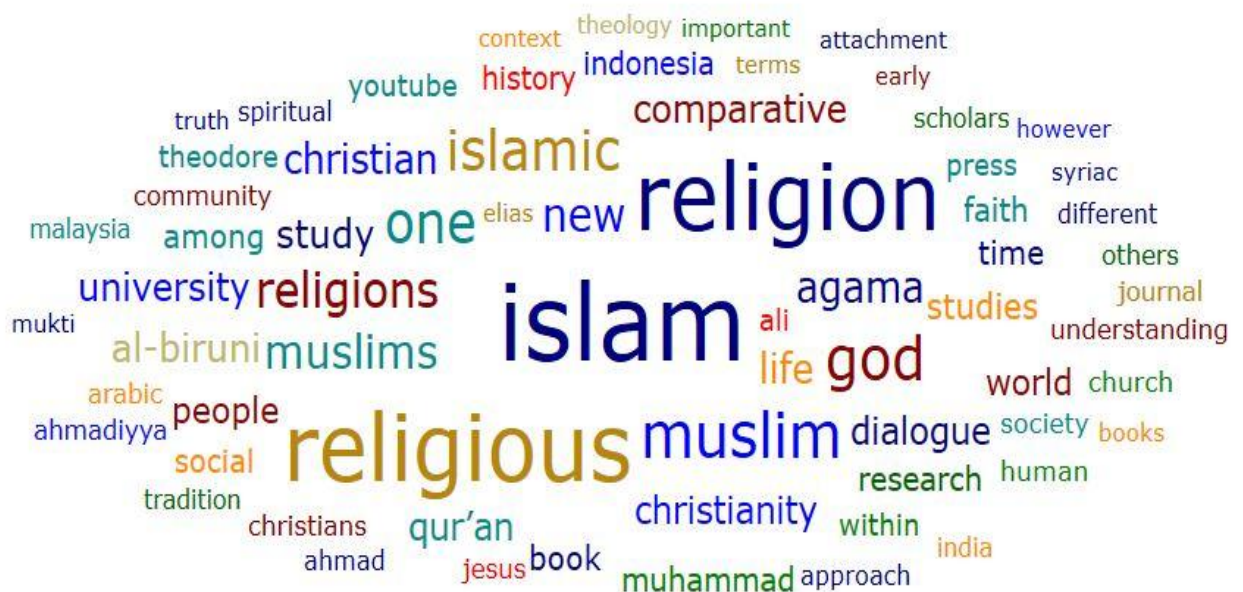


Figure 1: Word cloud generated from 27 articles



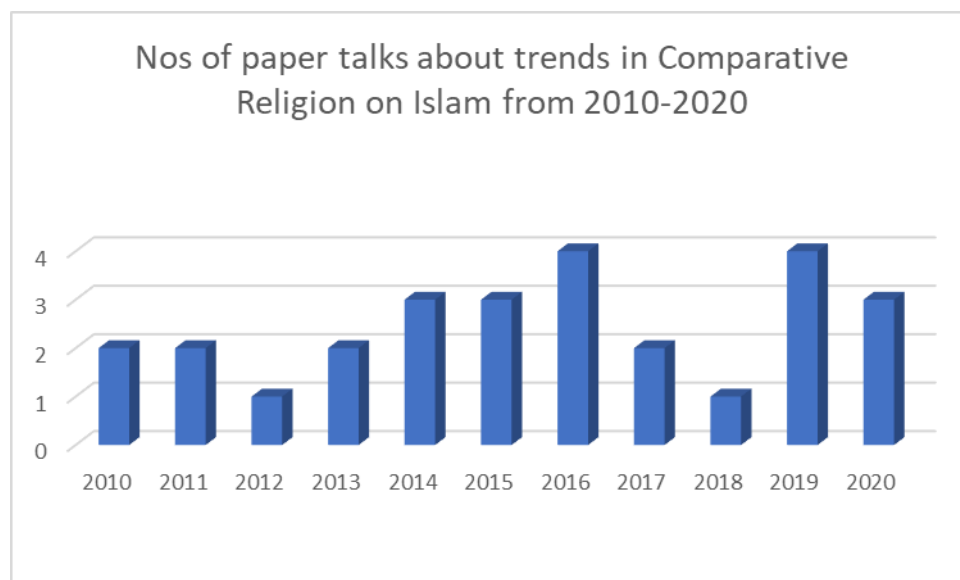


Figure 4: Paper breakdown according to the year of publication

9211

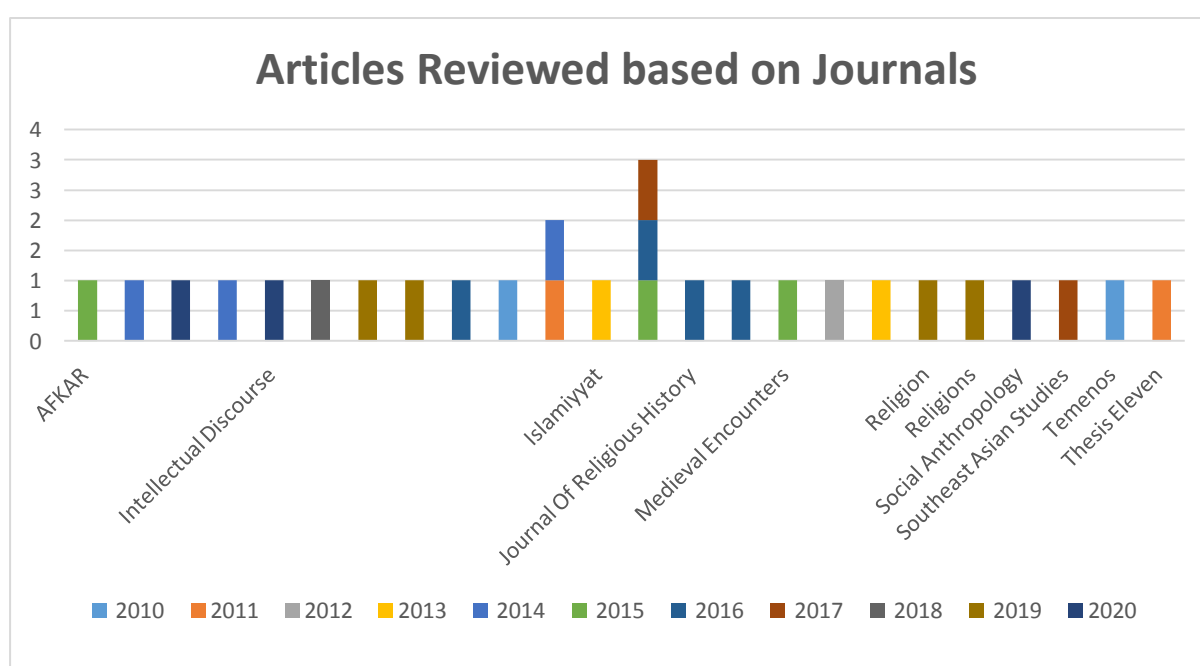


Figure 5: Articles reviewed based on Journals

	Academic & art	Concept of religion	Engagement Islam with others	Ideologies	People thought	Practice & sacred in religions	Young generation
(Anis et al. 2020)					√		



(Janson 2020)						√	
(Hofstad 2020)					√		
(De Wildt et al. 2019)	√						
(Mustapha & Razak 2019)					√		
(Senin et al. 2019)					√		
(Dakake 2019)		√					
(Daima et al. 2018)	√						
(Bahri 2017)				√			
(Parrott 2017)					√		
(Norizah Aripin et al. 2016)							√
(Lukenbill et al. 2016)							√
(Moreman 2016)						√	
(Burhani 2014)			√				
(Sabjan 2015)					√		
(Mugler 2015)					√		
(Bahri 2014)	√						
(Bertaina 2011)					√		
(Galadari 2010)						√	
(Miner et al. 2014)						√	
(Ruprecht et al. 2011)				√			
(Khambali et al. 2013)						√	
(Sakaranaho 2010)	√						
(Hamid & Hambali@Khambali 2015)					√		
(Ardi et al. 2016)					√		
(Lipman 2020)			√				
(Wan Haslan Khairuddin 2013)					√		

9212

Table 1: Documents in relation to theme

	Academic & art	Concept of religion	Engagement Islam with others	Ideologies	People thought	Practice & sacred in religions	Young generation	Totals
2010	1					1		2
2011				1	1			2



2013					1	1		2
2014	1		1			1		3
2015					3			3
2016					1	1	2	4
2017				1	1			2
2018	1							1
2019	1	1			2			4
2020			1		2	1		4

Table 2: The themes according to year

	2010	2011	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019	2020	Totals
Australia				1							1
Finlad	1										1
Germany									1		1
Hawaii										1	1
Indonesi a				2			1				3
Malaysia			2		2	2		1	2	1	10
Nigeria										1	1
UAE	1						1				2
USA		2			1	2			1	1	7

Table 3: The distribution of articles according to country

Qualitative findings

Based on the research question “What are the prevalent trends discussed in the literature about Comparative Religion on Islam from the year 2010 to 2020?”, the qualitative findings regarding comparative religion on Islam are illustrated in figure 6. The network diagram showed the identified 15 initial codes that later categorized into 7 main themes.

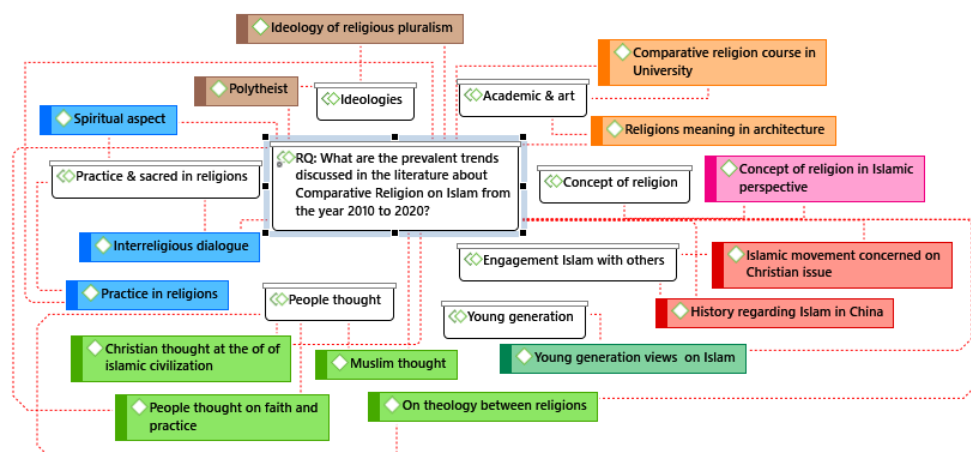
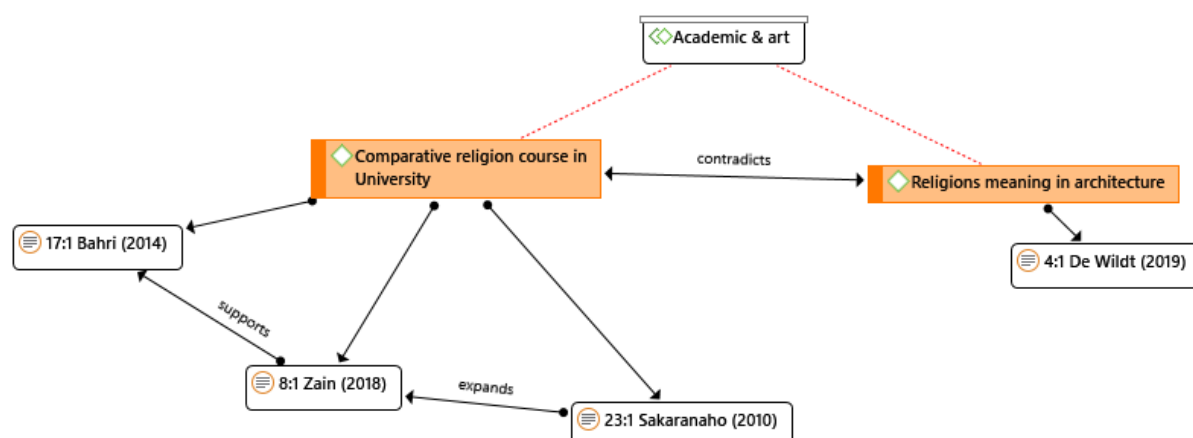


Figure 6: Network diagram on research question answered on the prevalent trends discussed in the literature from 2010-2020.



3.1 Academic and art



Theme 1: Academic & art

9214

Academic and art is one of the main themes that discussed in the literatures. With reference to a study conducted by (De Wildt et al. 2019 : 1) that concerns on the religious architecture which actually giving meaning for a certain religion. This can be seen from some of the specific religious architecture like church building, synagogues and mosques are not only considered as the places of worship for religious practices, community life and even the facilitation of religious experiences. But the building itself has their own symbolic and represents religious identity and power. On the other thing, the author also mentioned in their finding on this paper that the religious architecture also brings to the people of that religion a motivation aspect. These things has been proven from their four analytical dimensions studying on this issue which are a] the visual shape of the architecture and its ascribed meaning; b] the interplay with and referentiality to urban space; c] the religious and non-religious intentions and motivations connected to the building project; d] the social and cultural context in which the construction activity is situated.

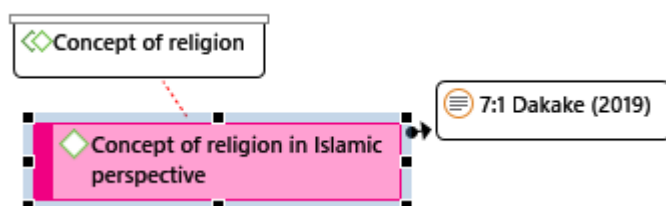
Meanwhile, in terms of academic aspect discussed about comparative religion on Islam is referring to the higher education course. As reference by (Bahri 2014:155 ; Zain et al. 2018:186) focused their studies on Asian country which is Malaysia and Indonesia, meanwhile (Sakaranaho 2010:215) is focusing on Finland. What is interesting discussed by the authors from Asian country, the population of their people is multiracial community, so the element of inculcating unity, tolerance and mutual understanding between one another is very important to make sure the harmonious country achieved. In order to have harmonious between people of religions, one main thing need to introduce to them is the course on comparative religion.

Difference with (Sakaranaho 2010:216) which majority people in Finland is Christian. Other thing that emphasized in this paper which Finnish study on Islam is variety which conducted by Arabists, comparative religionists, theologians, anthropologists and social scientists, even it closed focus on central themes and methodologies. Beside that, in terms of recent Finnish studies on Islam and Muslims, there are main interest topics on that studies which are studies dealing with the foundational sources of Islam and subsequent theological questions; studies of Muslims in Muslim-populated countries; and the last one is studies of Muslims and Islam in Europe and Finland.



Nevertheless, there is need for further research on the exploration in terms of academic field in learning on comparative religion with field work aspect such as how far the engagement between the students with people of other religions.

3.2 Concept of religion

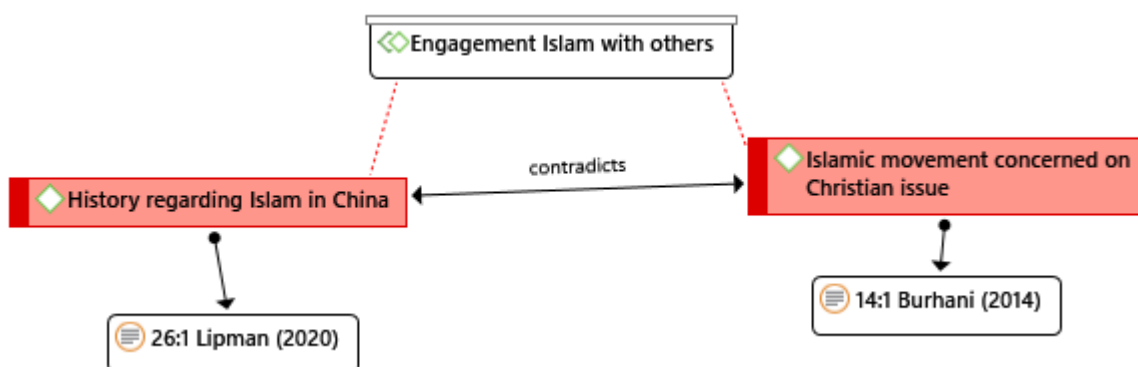


Theme 2: Concept of religion

The second theme is about concept of religion discussed by (Dakake 2019:345) which focused on three key words under the Islamic perspective on religion. They are religion (din), submission to God (Islam) and faith/belief (iman) in which extended also to the study of religion. The term of religion (din) itself gives several meanings, which are religion as universal and particular; the interiority of religion; as dynamic and relational; as personal 'orientation' toward God. Meanwhile, Islam in the al-Quran is a true religion and it is about submission to God. Likewise, Iman in the Quran is about faith and belief. Unfortunately, the author mentioned that some people in the contemporary world use these two terms 'Islam and Iman' through the perspective of their literal translations, such as they understand on the terms of Islam or Muslim represent specifically the religion and followers of Muhammad, while the terms 'faith/belief/believer' is referred to all forms of religious adherence. Hence, it meant that in terms of the concept of religion giving meaningful value for certain religion and it is important for people who want to study more on others, they have to know the philosophy of things that they want to study.

9215

3.3 Engagement Islam with other



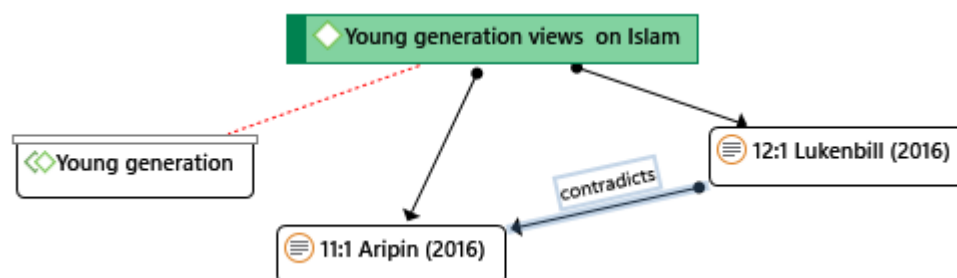
Theme 3: Engagement Islam with others

The third theme is engagement Islam with others which also related with comparative religion on Islam. The engagement Islam with others can be seen from the commitment of the Ahmadiyya movement approached towards Christianity (Burhani 2014:145). As for some of Ahmadiyya literature on Christianity is well-known for its apologetics, controversial and polemic character towards them. Even, its influence under the field of comparative religion especially Christianity can



be categorized into two aspects; mission activities and academic field. Like religious missionary activity is in Ahmadiyya literatures on Christianity which resulted enhancement of Muslims' confidence in their religion when they learn about religion in comparative way. Meanwhile in terms of academic field is about the study of comparative religion in Islamic higher education whereas the influence of Ahmadiyya books can be seen from some of the Muslim scholars like Lubis and Hasbullah Bakry use it in their lectures. As far as Ahmadiyya's movement enhanced Muslim's confidence in their religion and its recognized by some scholars, but there is some lacking in terms of building good relationship between Muslim-Christianity without propagating religious pluralism towards people of other religions.

3.4 Young generation



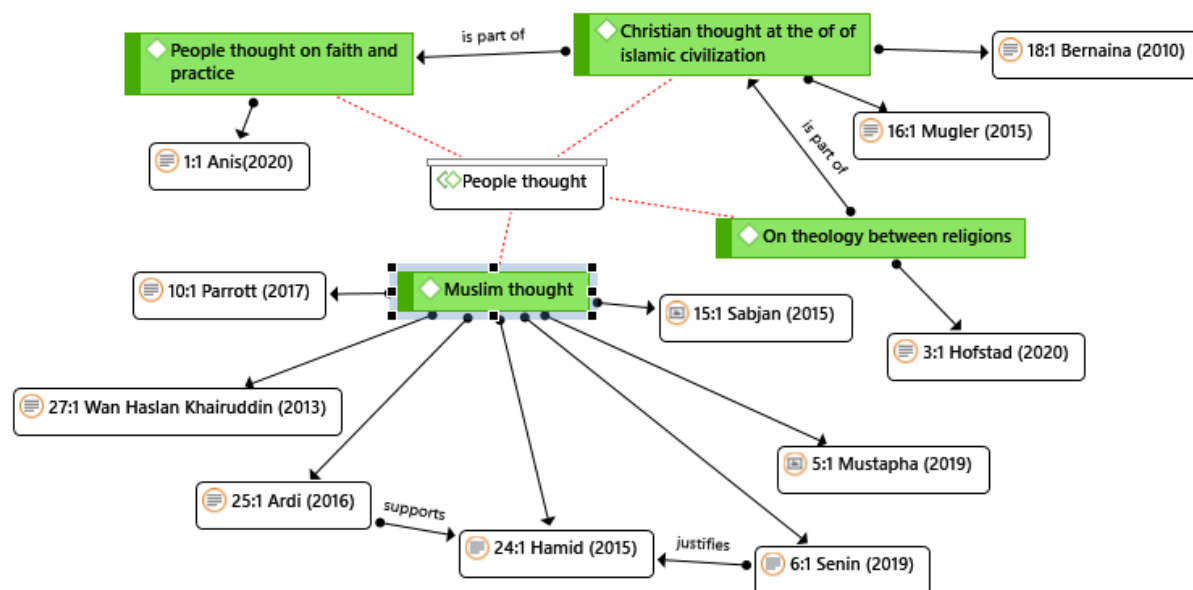
9216

Theme 4: Young generation

Then, the next theme is about young generation views on Islam which both studies from the different context discussion. With reference to a study conducted by (Lukenbill et al. 2016:32) is actually focusing on book that written by two people which is Florence Mary Fitch (Allah, the God of Islam: Moslem life and worship) and Reza Aslan (No God but God: the origins, evolution of Islam) which directed their book about Islam for youth. Both authors have their similarity which the written books are leading to youth and both received academic training in religion and served in the American academic community as professors. By comparing both books, (Lukenbill et al. 2016:38) mentioned in his conclusion; firstly about Aslan intentions in his book directly explaining the humanity and democratic teaching of the prophet, he stated that there are many of the misinterpretations of the Quran and from Muhammad's mission growth long after his death and resulted social and cultural conflicts. Meanwhile, Fitch intentions in her book believed that Muhammad's military conquests related with forced conversions. Even, in certain context, she believed that some Muslims are backward and she supported on progressive Muslims in Egypt, Turkey and Pakistan who want to modernize but still remained faith of Islam. Nevertheless, there is still lacking in current literature discussed on these accusations and misconceptions as far as the religion is concerned.



3.5 People thoughts



9217

Theme 5: People thoughts

People thought's theme is the most studies have discussed in the publication. This theme is conquered by muslim thought on comparative religion which referring to al-Biruni, Shahrastani, Imam al-Ghazali, Rahmatullah al-Kairanawi and Zakir Naik. With reference to a studies conducted by (Ardi et al. 2016:1 ; Hamid & Hambali@Khambali 2015:1 ; Senin et al. 2019:2), all of three publications mentioned on al-Biruni's methodology in approaching the people of other religions. Based on al-Biruni's kitab al-Hind (Hamid & Hambali@Khambali 2015:13) discovered on al-Biruni's approaches in order to achieve the harmonious among religious co-existence. There are some approaches that found in this book which are being objectivity, knowledgeable in the field of the study, authoritative sources of reference, having dialogue with the community of studies.

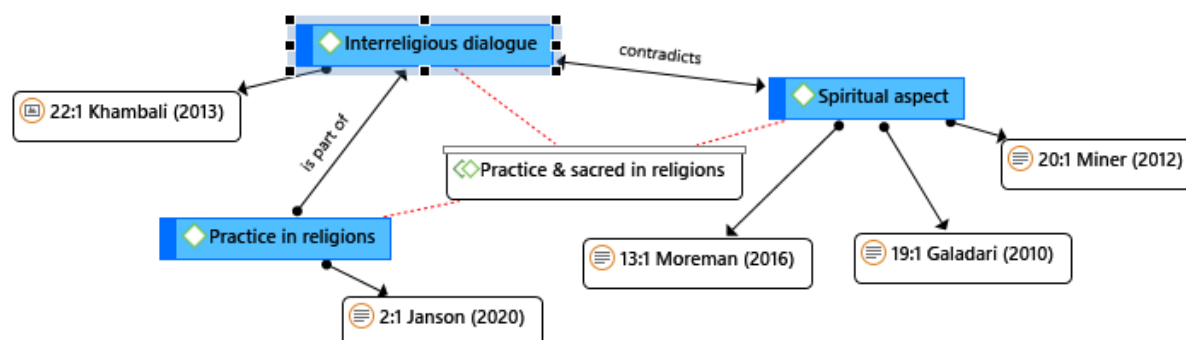
Similarly with (Ardi et al. 2016:4) is also doing research based on al-Biruni's kitab al-Hind which focused on critical thinking of this scholar. Referred to the several theory of critical thinking, the author found that 1] al-Biruni is not only scholar of comparative religion but also knowledgeable in various dan diverse science; 2] Mastering several languages; 3] Asking question is a means of precise comprehension; 4] Judgement and conclusion based on evidence; 5] Look of connection between subjects; 6] Fairness in dealing with other; 7] Logic arguments; 8] Honest with himself and the last one is 9] Integrating between the reason and the revelation. As well (Senin et al. 2019:8) who also studied on al-Biruni's kitab al-Hind discovered that there are three main approaches in studying the people of other religions which is 1] Systematic data collection; 2] Historical account and analysis; 3] Comparison.

Meanwhile, the study conducted by (Mustapha & Abdul Razak 2019:71) is quiet difference with above studies on Muslim thought whereas she studied on contemporary Muslim thought which is Zakir Naik. The study focused the same like (Ardi et al. 2016:1 ; Hamid & Hambali@Khambali 2015:1 ; Senin et al. 2019:3) studied about approach and methodology of the Muslim scholar of comparative religion, then the study discovered several approaches which are 1] Controversial statement; 2] Unclear methodology; 3] Obscure name. The study also analysed some



recommendation regarding on this paper like as a preacher need to employ diplomacy and persuasion, avoiding provocation questions and others. Equally important that regarding in this theme, need for doing comparison study on more than one Muslim scholar in comparative religion with another in terms of certain issue that relevant in our real time. Even, it is also described that the needed for bringing and uphold the Muslim thoughts in facing and living our plural society that we have in this world in the line of the right teaching according to Islamic views.

3.6 Practice and sacred in religions



9218

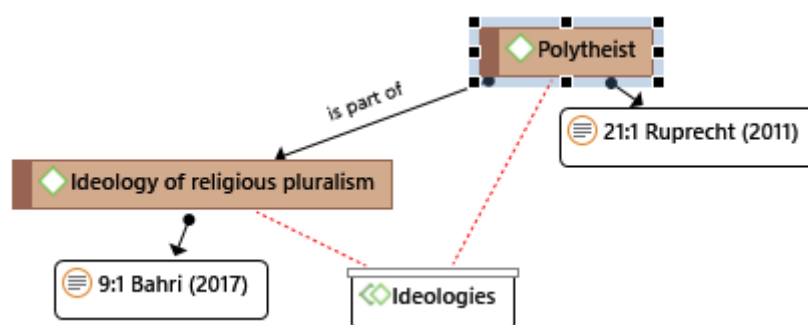
Theme 6: Practice & sacred in religions

The second last theme is practice and sacred in religions which also discussed in the publication. As mentioned by the studies conducted by (Janson 2020:418 ; Sintang et al. 2013:1599), both focused on some practical aspect in religions. Such (Sintang et al. 2013:1603) realized on interfaith dialogue especially dialogue of life is very important in order to promoting harmonious among people of the other religions. Based on the case study on of the Teratak Fitrah's role in Sabah which not only as a guidance center for new Muslims but also promoting correlation among Muslim community in Sabah, the study found that the main role of this organization is its role in practising dialogue of life among religious community. As mentioned also in study which there are several types of interfaith dialogues and each has their own criteria. Such dialogue of life is inclusive categories which unstructured communication between people of different religions, even this dialogue can take place in markets and street corners.

On the other hand, from several studies conducted by (Galadari 2010:245 ; Miner et al. 2012:1 ; Moreman 2017:1) focusing on the sacred aspect or sacred attachment in religions. Like (Miner et al. 2014:2) studied on the comparison between Islam-Christianity in terms of spiritual attachment. The study identified the relationship between dimensions of attachment, corresponding experiences, cognition and behaviours and related theological themes. What is interesting in the author analysis on the study, they believed that Islam-Christianity's sacred text and mystical writing has relationship between a believer and God harmoniously, but in terms of practical concern for assessing, understanding and potentially changing an individual's relations to God, both religions have some differences.



3.7 Ideologies



Theme 7: Ideologies

The last theme is ideologies which referred to one of the Indonesia society on its idea of religious pluralism (Bahri 2017:139) and the other study by (Ruprecht et al. 2011:118) discussed on polytheist America.

With reference to a study conducted by (Bahri 2017:142), it explained on historically on the emergence of theosophy in Indonesia which originally come from theosophical movement in New York. The main idea of religious pluralism that propagating by ITS is the concept of God. They believe on esoteric which is God is one, but believers call Him by different names such as the Dutch call Him 'God', Muslims 'Allah Taala', Hindus 'Ishwara', Tionghua or Chinese 'Kwan-shai-Yin Thian', Jews 'Jenovah', Confucians 'Tao' and Greeks 'Theo'. Regarding on this issue, the ideology of religious pluralism brought by ITS is quite dangerous because there are many writing on Islam by ITS magazines. Even, the author also recommends on future study on the commonalities between the Theosophical organization and Freemasonry because based on Indonesia context, there is also freemasons work in Indonesia.

Discussion and future studies

In summary, this paper regards that the comparative religion on Islam is tremendously discussed not only studied by the Muslim researcher but also Western researcher in this

field. It means that some people regardless their religiosity have the intention to study the field of comparative religion on Islam. As far as the discussion regarding comparative religion on Islam is concerned, the researchers believed the important to the field of comparative religion on Islam in the right view.

In addition, due to the limitation of this study which is focusing on thematic review comparative religion on Islam, the researchers suggest for some recommendations for future studies. Firstly, is the need to do more research on the contemporary Muslims methodologies in this field in terms certain issue such as in preaching or in writing. This is because, as far as the researchers concerned on the approach or methodology in this field, there are studies from the literatures showed that some of Muslim approaches towards the people of the religions is different from time to time. Like al-Biruni's approaches and Zakir Naik's approaches towards people of other religion are different. Hence, which approach and methodology that can reflect for our contemporary life? Therefore, some future studies should focus on this issue.

Second thing is about the sacred aspects in religions such as theology or prophethood in religion. The researchers



believed that foundational aspect in religions especially Abrahamic faith, there are some similarities and also differences. This can be seen from religious scriptures as a foundation part to explore more on this. Therefore, future study can be explored more on the themes on religious scriptures which having the similarities and also differences.

Contributions and benefits of study

Last but not least, from the suggestion for future studies showed that how important to cross the discipline of study which is not only in the field of comparative religion alone, but cross discipline can be in multimedia field, da'wa field, architecture field and so on.

As far as the trends on comparative religion on Islam from the review are concerned, we realize that several themes such academic & art, concept of religion, engagement Islam with others, people thought, young generation, ideologies and practice & sacred in religions, all of these bring a new knowledge for the readers especially the researchers in the field of comparative religion as followed:

1. Most of the literatures of publication between 2010-2020 from the author from Malaysia
2. Most of the trends of discussion of the literatures is about people thought
3. The needs for further study to some themes that related with comparative religion on Islam.

References

- Anis, R. B., Hasan, M. M. & Mahmudul Hasan, M. 2020. Faith and Practice: Islamic Perspectives on Robert Browning. *INTELLECTUAL DISCOURSE* 28(1): 129–148.
- Ardi, M. N., Abdullah, F. binti & Al-Tamimi, S. 2016. Al-Biruni : A Muslim Critical Thinker. *International Journal of Nusantara Islam* 04(01): 1–12.
- Bahri, M. Z. 2014. Teaching religions in Indonesian Islamic higher education: From Comparative Religion to Religious Studies. *Indonesian Journal of Islam and Muslim Societies* 4(2): 155–188. doi:10.18326/ijims.v4i2.155-188
- Bahri, M. Z. 2017. Indonesian Theosophical Society (1900-40) and the Idea of Religious Pluralism. *SOUTHEAST ASIAN STUDIES* 6(1): 139–165. doi:10.20495/seas.6.1_139
- Bertaina, D. 2011. Science, syntax, and superiority in eleventh-century Christian-Muslim discussion: Elias of Nisibis on the Arabic and Syriac languages. *Islam and Christian-Muslim Relations* 22(2): 197–207. doi:10.1080/09596410.2011.560433
- Burhani, A. N. 2014. The Ahmadiyya and the Study of Comparative Religion in Indonesia: Controversies and Influences. *Islam and Christian-Muslim Relations* 25(2): 141–158. doi:10.1080/09596410.2013.864191
- Clarke, V. & Braun, V. 2013. Teaching thematic analysis : Overcoming challenges and developing strategies for effective learning Associate Professor in Sexuality Studies Department of Psychology Faculty of Health and Life Sciences University of the West of England Coldharbour Lane Br. *University of the West of England* 26: 120–123.
- Daima, A., Zain, M., Ali, S., Syed, H., Syed, O., Mohd, W., Firdaus, K., et al. 2018. Article ID: IJCIET_09_13_020 Religion Course in Unisza in Forming Interreligion Dialogue Among Students. *International Journal of*



- Civil Engineering and Technology (IJCIET* 9(13): 186–193. Retrieved from <http://www.iaeme.com/ijciyet/issues.asp?JType=IJCIET&VType=9&IType=13http://www.iaeme.com/IJCIET/index.asp187editor@iaeme.comhttp://www.iaeme.com/IJCIET/issues.asp?JType=IJCIET&VType=9&IType=13>
- Dakake, M. M. 2019. Qur’anic terminology, translation, and the Islamic conception of religion. *RELIGION* 49(3, SI): 343–363. doi:10.1080/0048721X.2019.1622837
- De Wildt, K., Radermacher, M., Krech, V., Loeffler, B., Sonne, W., Löffler, B., Sonne, W., et al. 2019. Transformations of ‘Sacredness in Stone’: Religious Architecture in Urban Space in 21st Century Germany-New Perspectives in the Study of Religious Architecture. *RELIGIONS* 10(11): 1–16. doi:10.3390/rel10110602
- Galadari, A. 2010. Humanity’s ultimate sacrifice: Parallelism between Christ’s crucifixion and Islamic Hajj. *International Journal of the Humanities* 8(1): 245–254. Retrieved from <https://www.scopus.com/inward/record.uri?eid=2-s2.0-84863693257&partnerID=40&md5=a3ed41131dee2b439f7f05d7c05102b>
- Hamid, S. A. & Hambali@Khambali, K. M. 2015. Pemerkasaan Keharmonian Masyarakat Beragama: Rujukan Pendekatan Al-Biruni Berdasarkan Karyanya Kitab Al-Hind. *AFKAR* 16: 1–30.
- Hassan, K. 2014. The Role of Private Electronic Media in Radicalising The Role of Private Electronic Media in Radicalising Pakistan. *The Round Table* 103(1): 65–81. doi:10.1080/00358533.2013.874164
- Hofstad, L. 2020. The challenges of comparative theology: An assessment of Kärkkäinen’s Doing the work of comparative theology. Retrieved from <https://www.scopus.com/inward/record.uri?eid=2-s2.0-85089987912&doi=10.1111%2Fdia1.12602&partnerID=40&md5=b63d375161753bc9017076bee7b5e9eb>
- Janson, M. 2020. Crossing borders: the case of NASFAT or ‘Pentecostal Islam’ in Southwest Nigeria. *Social Anthropology* 28(2): 418–433. doi:10.1111/1469-8676.12769
- Khambali, K. M., Sintang, S., Senin, N. & Shahrud-Din, S. 2013. Interfaith dialogue in the context of comparative religion. *Middle East Journal of Scientific Research* 14(12): 1599–1612. doi:10.5829/idosi.mejsr.2013.14.12.11017
- Lipman, J. 2020. Epilogue to “Islam in China / China in Islam” E. *Cross-currents: East Asian History and Culture Review* 3(2): 601–609.
- Lukenbill, W. B. B., Lukenbill, W B Lukenbill, W. B. 2016. W. about I. for Y. A. S. of T. A. and T. W. V. R. from <https://www.scopus.com/inward/record.uri?eid=2-s2.0-84975894205&doi=10.1080%2F10477845.2016.1168337&partnerID=40&md5=fb2c3accb00299224b13eec003c9a61> & Lukenbill, W. B. B. 2016. Writing about Islam for Youth: A Study of Two Authors and Two World Views. *Journal of Religious and Theological Information* 15(1–2): 32–46. doi:10.1080/10477845.2016.1168337
- Miner, M., Ghobary, B., Dowson, M. & Proctor, M. T. M.-T. 2012. Spiritual attachment in Islam and Christianity: similarities and differences. *Mental*



- Health, Religion and Culture* 17(1): 79–93. doi:10.1080/13674676.2012.749452
- Miner, M., Ghobary, B., Dowson, M. & Proctor, M. T. M.-T. 2014. Spiritual attachment in Islam and Christianity: similarities and differences. *Mental Health, Religion and Culture* 17(1): 79–93. doi:10.1080/13674676.2012.749452
- Moreman, C. M. 2016. Rehabilitating the Spirituality of Pre-Islamic Arabia: On the Importance of the Kahin, the Jinn, and the Tribal Ancestral Cult. *JOURNAL OF RELIGIOUS HISTORY* 41(2): 137–157. doi:10.1111/1467-9809.12383
- Moreman, C. M. 2017. Rehabilitating the Spirituality of Pre-Islamic Arabia: On the Importance of the Kahin, the Jinn, and the Tribal Ancestral Cult. *JOURNAL OF RELIGIOUS HISTORY* 41(2): 137–157. doi:10.1111/1467-9809.12383
- Mugler, J. 2015. Theodore Abu qurra and the instability of “Heresy.” *Medieval Encounters* 21(1): 1–25. Retrieved from <https://www.scopus.com/inward/record.uri?eid=2-s2.0-84927132385&doi=10.1163%2F15700674-12342181&partnerID=40&md5=e91b6128d20aaf20b79700bd8d77699e>
- Mustapha, M. & Abdul Razak, M. A. 2019. A Critical Appraisal of Zakir Naik’s Islamic Evangelism. *International Journal of Islamic Thought* 15(1): 71–83. doi:10.24035/ijit.15.2019.007
- Musthafa, J. 2014. Mediation and Muhammad’s Message: Characteristics of Online Islamic Evangelism Consumed by Indian Youth. *Jurnal Pengajian Media Malaysia* 16(1): 13–24.
- Norizah Aripin, Ismail, A., Ishak, M. S., Rahman, N. A. A., Rahman, M. N. A., Madon, M. & Mustaffa, M. F. 2016. “Youtube” Dan Generasi Muda Islam: Satu Pendekatan Kelompok Fokus Dalam Kalangan Pelajar Universiti. *Journal Komunikasi* 32(1): 165–188.
- Nussio, E. 2020. Attitudinal and Emotional Consequences of Islamist Terrorism . Evidence from the Berlin Attack. *Political Psychology* 0(0): 1–21. doi:10.1111/pops.12679
- Parrott, J. 2017. Al-Ghazali and the Golden Rule: Ethics of Reciprocity in the Works of a Muslim Sage. *Journal of Religious and Theological Information* 16(2): 68–78. doi:10.1080/10477845.2017.1281067
- Ruprecht, L. A., Ruprecht Jr., L. A. & Ruprecht, L. A. 2011. What is the matter in a polytheist America? *Thesis Eleven* 105(1): 118–129. doi:10.1177/0725513611407453
- Sabjan, M. A. 2015. Early Muslim Scholarship in Religionwissenschaft: A Study of Muhammad ‘Abd Al-Karīm Al-Shahrastānī’s On the Concept of the People of a Dubious Book (Ahl Shubhat Kitāb). *Journal of Religious and Theological Information* 14(3–4): 79–85. doi:10.1080/10477845.2015.1085787
- Sakaranaho, T. 2010. Finnish Studies on Islam : Themes and Approaches. *Temenos* 46(2): 215–249.
- Senin, N., Grine, F., Wan Ramli, W. A., Mohd Khambali @ Hambali, K. & Ramlan, S. F. 2019. Understanding the ‘other’: the case of Al-Biruni (973-1048 AD). *International Journal of Ethics and Systems* 35(3): 392–409. doi:10.1108/IJOES-01-2018-0010
- Sintang, S., Khambali, K. M., Baharuddin, A., Senin, N., Shaharud-din, S., Yon, W. A.



- W., Malek, B., et al. 2013. The Dialogue of Hikma: Generating Harmony in Muslim-Non-Muslim Relations. *Islam and Christian-Muslim Relations* 24(2): 213–224.
doi:10.1080/09596410.2013.772328
- Soratto, J., Pires, D. E. P. de & Friese, S. 2020. Thematic content analysis using ATLAS . ti software : Potentialities for researchs in health. *Revista Brasileira de Enfermagem* 73(3): 1–5.
- Wan Haslan Khairuddin, I. I. & J. A. 2013. Pemikiran Kritis Rahmatullah al-Kairanawi dalam Religionswissenschaft. *Islamiyyat* 35(1): 57–63.
- Yogesh Hole et al 2019 J. Phys.: Conf. Ser. 1362 012121
- Zain, A. D. M., Ali, M. S., Syed Omar, S. H. & Wan Khairuldin, W. M. K. F. 2018. The role of comparative religion course in Unisza in forming interreligion dialogue among students. *International Journal of Civil Engineering and Technology* 9(13): 186–193.
- Zairul, M. 2020. A thematic review on student-centred learning in the studio education. *Journal of Critical Reviews* 7(2): 504–511. doi:10.31838/jcr.07.02.95

